
HS 303: Partition of India: History and Legacy

Course Code	HS 303
Course Name	Partition of India: History and Legacy
L-T-P-C	3-0-0-3
Prerequisites	None
Intended for	B.Tech. (7th and 8th Semesters)
Mutual Exclusion	None
Approval	50th BoA (Jul 2023)

Course Contents

- Unit 1: Why is Partition history important? (1 hour) [R3 suggestion incorporated and this new unit has been added.]
 - Interrogating popular understandings of Partition
 - Partition as event and process
- Unit 2: Trauma and Memory: Methodologies Old and New (4 hours)
 - What is the relationship between history and memory?
 - Interrogating the archive
 - Potentials and limitations of oral history [R3 suggestion has been incorporated and ‘pitfalls’ has been replaced with ‘limitations’.]
- Unit 3: The High Politics of Partition (10 hours)
 - Majorities and minorities in a colonial context: Issues of representation and power
 - Elections of 1937 and 1946
 - Negotiations: The Congress, the Muslim League, and the British
- Unit 4: The Partition in Punjab and Bengal: Varying Trends and Trajectories (6 hours)
 - Patterns of violence
 - Refugee relief and rehabilitation
- Unit 5: Impact on Cities (5 hours)
 - Evacuee property: custodians and claims
 - Delhi
 - Calcutta
- Unit 6: Neglected Histories of Partition (6 hours)
 - Gender – the recovery of ‘abducted’ women
 - Caste – challenging the idea of the monolithic refugee
 - Region – the experience of Sindh
- Unit 7: The ‘Long Partition’: The Impact of Partition on Indian Polity (4 hours)
 - Minority rights in the Indian Constitution
 - Citizenship: short-term and long-term trends
 - Partition’s shadow on the India-Pakistan relationship [R3 suggestion has been incorporated.]
- Unit 7: Representing the Partition in Literature and Film (6 hours)

- Literature – short stories by Rajinder Singh Bedi, Saadat Hasan Manto, Intizar Husain and Ismat Chughtai. Source book: Bhalla, Alok (ed.). Stories about the Partition of India, Vols I-III. Publishers, 2011.
- Film Ghatak, Ritwik. Meghe Dhaka Tara [The Cloud-Capped Star], 1960. Sumar, Sabiha. Khamosh Paani [Silent Waters], 2004.

Text Books

1. Khan Yasmin, The Great Partition: The Making of India and Pakistan. Yale University Press, 2008.
- Roy, Haimanti. The Partition of India. Oxford University Press, 2018.

References

1. Butalia Urvashi. The Other Side of Silence: Voices from the Partition of India. Penguin, 1998.
2. Chatterji Joya. Bengal Divided: Hindu Communalism and Partition, 1932- 1947. Cambridge University Press, 1995.
3. Chatterji, Joya. Spoils of Partition: Bengal and India, 1947–1967. Cambridge University Press, 2007. [R1 suggestion incorporated.]
4. Das, Veena. ‘National Honour and Practical Kinship: Of Unwanted Women and Children’. In Critical Events: An Anthropological Perspective on Contemporary India. Oxford University Press, 1995.
5. Gauba, Kanika. “Forgetting Partition: Constitutional Amnesia and Nationalism.” Economic and Political Weekly, vol. 51, no. 39, 2016, pp. 41–47. [R1 suggestion incorporated.]
6. Hasan Mushirul (ed.). India’s Partition: Process, Strategy and Mobilization. Oxford University Press, 2001.
7. Jalal, Ayesha. The Sole Spokesman: Jinnah, the Muslim League and the Demand for Pakistan. Cambridge University Press, 1994.
8. Kaul Suvir (ed.), The Partitions of Memory: The Afterlife of the Division of India. Permanent Black, 2001.
9. Kaur, Ravinder. Since 1947: Partition Narratives among Punjabi Migrants of Delhi. Oxford University Press, 2007.
10. Malhotra, Aanchal. Remnants of a Separation: 21 Objects from a Continent Divided. Hurst & Co. 2019.
11. Menon Ritu and Kamala Bhasin. Borders and Boundaries: Women in India’s Partition. Kali for Women, 2000.
12. Nair, Neeti. Changing Homelands: Hindu Politics and the Partition of India. Harvard University Press, 2011.
13. Pandey, Gyanendra. Remembering Partition: Violence, Nationalism and History in India. Cambridge University Press, 2001.
14. Talbot, Ian and Gurharpal Singh. The Partition of India. Cambridge University Press, 2009.
15. Tan Tai Yong and Gyanesh Kudaisya. The Aftermath of Partition. Routledge, 2000.
16. Zamindar, Vazira Fazila. The Long Partition and the Making of Modern South Asia. Columbia University Press, 2007.
17. Primary source repository: 1947 Partition Archive (<https://in.1947partitionarchive.org/>)